

71 Suggestions and explanations

In reported speech, you can replace “said” with a wide variety of verbs that give people more information about how someone said something.

 **New language** Reporting verbs with “that”

 **Vocabulary** More reporting verbs

 **New skill** Reporting explanations

71.1 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTING VERBS WITH “THAT”

“Say” and “tell” do not give any information about the speaker’s manner. You can replace them with other verbs that suggest the speaker’s mood or reason for speaking.

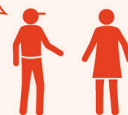


I’m not very good at golf.

Neil **admitted** **that** he wasn’t very good at golf.

Shows reluctance on the part of the speaker.

Reporting verbs with “that” do not take an object.



71.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES REPORTING VERBS WITH “THAT”



Don’t be afraid of the dog. He’s just excited to see you.

They **explained** **that** the dog was barking because he was excited to see me.



Your house is beautiful. It has a nice lawn, too.

Rohit admired our house, and **added** **that** it had a nice lawn.



71.3 HOW TO FORM SENTENCES USING REPORTING VERBS WITH “THAT”

SUBJECT

REPORTING VERB (PAST TENSE)

“THAT”

PAST TENSE

Neil

admitted

that

he wasn’t very good at golf.

Verb introduces reported speech and gives more information about it.

Verb is followed by “that.”

Reported speech changes tense as usual.